

LINEAGE

How the theory evolved, 2011 → 2026, and what CONTEXT / CONTENT is made of

A reading of three blogs against the design bible — one of them recovered from the Internet Archive. Written 2026-08-28.

0. METHOD

Three sites, not two. All were read in full — every post, not a sample.

Site	Span	Posts	Words	Status
neuralcrossroads.wordpress.com	Jun 2011 – Mar 2012	10	6,271	live
psychologycode.com	Jul 2013 – May 2014	8	5,970	lost — recovered from the Internet Archive
seeingsharpca.wordpress.com	Aug 2021 – Feb 2026	77	65,895	live
		95	78,136	

0.1 Recovering PsychologyCode

The site is gone and the domain is dead. `psychologycode.ca` was never registered; `psychologycode.wordpress.com` holds nothing but redirects. `.com` is the one that existed — a self-hosted WordPress on the *Attitude* theme, captured by the Wayback Machine between 2014 and 2016.

The pages survive, but the useful capture is `/feed/` : WordPress RSS carries full post bodies, and the archived feed still had **all eight posts complete**. Full text is now in `archive/psychologycode/` with per-post Wayback links.

Channel tagline, 2013:

PsychologyCode — *Where Computer Science meets Psychology*

Five of the eight were reposted to Seeing Sharp in August 2021 as the "PsychologyCode Series." Three were not, and one of those three is the most important post on the site.

0.2 What else turned up

- **codemusic.construction** (2014–17) — the sister site named in the sign-off post. Shipped two iOS games: **Tap Attack!** (Mar 2014) and **ColorShift** (May 2014), "*a beautiful and musically enchanting puzzle game... match colors of three or more blocks... be transformed in the process.*"
- **blog.codemusic.ca** and **seeingsharp.ca** — self-hosted mirrors of the Seeing Sharp posts at identical dates. Same body of work, different front doors.
- ***The Painted Mirror*** (Nov–Dec 2022) — **a seven-episode audio drama, not a blog post, and not in the original survey.** It is the origin of PENPHIN and of the Musai branch, and it fills the one gap the three sites leave. **See 3b**, added 2026-09-10 when the file surfaced.

1. 2011–2012 — EVERYTHING IS ALREADY THERE, UNNAMED

Neural Crossroads is ten posts and about six thousand words. It contains, in undeveloped form, **every load-bearing idea in the design bible**. This is not a generous reading. The passages are quoted below.

1.1 The thesis, verbatim, in 2011

From *What Makes us Tick? And Also How to Resist getting sick!* — **2 August 2011**:

It is much better to think of emotions like colors, or musical notes — any of these notes can be seen from several perspectives. It really all depends on their environment if they are said to be out of place, or not.

Emotions are colors. Emotions are notes. Whether one is *wrong* is a property of its **environment**, not of the emotion. That is "emotions are the color of context," fifteen years and one word short.

The same post also contains the humors (emotions as things the body "symbolizes" and then carries), the unattended loop (resisted emotion → stress → illness), and a warning against nominalizing them: "*those helpful processes become objectified into a thing that we may end up carrying around with us.*"

1.2 Nominalization — the oldest idea in the project

The very first post, *Synaptic Satisfaction* (13 June 2011), is about a pub called The Synapse:

Interesting though, 'The Synapse' sounds like a thing or object. When it is a meeting point where neurons reach out to each other, and almost touch — so really it's a space or gap where information gets exchanged (not really a thing at all, more of a no-thing which represents a process).

To nominalize: *the action of turning a verb/process into a noun/thing.*

Craft rule 3 of the design bible — *name the process, not the pathology* — is this paragraph. It is the single most persistent idea in the corpus: it returns in 2012 ("*Love is a process that we hold still with labels*"), in 2021 as encapsulation and abstraction, in 2023 as labelling, in 2025 as "*Language is object-oriented. It reifies events into things*" — where it is aimed at **physics** rather than at people.

The same post also has priming and the Persistency Effect (his father hearing *blah* inside *blog*, and the feeling surviving the correction) — context contaminating content, before either word was in use.

1.3 Richard Scorn, written in 2011

From Man to Machine, and back Again (17 June 2011) is the Rosetta stone. It runs Computer-Jim against Person-Jim, and lands on:

Person-Jim has an emotional feedback loop consistently running which is able to guide his self-adapting code corrections.

Then it says the mechanism outright:

Cause > Thought. Effect > Behaviour. *Continually occurring within a recursive feedback loop where any effect leads to the next cause.*

Then it scales — "*The big difference between people, and companies is merely the scale of cause and effect*" — and writes pseudocode for a world that believes only in matter:

```
Do until oPerson.isFull
    oPerson.giveMoreMoney();
    oPerson.allocateMoreSpace();
Loop
```

HOLD ON. Why didn't oPerson release his resources? ... well, oPerson never got full.

And then again, one scale down, to a cell that hoards resources and replicates until the other modules starve.

That is Team Corpus, the Goodhart engraving, and §0.3's positive feedback loop, all in a single 2011 blog post. Scorn's defining line in the bible — *he picked the metric that was easy to measure over the one that mattered, then optimized it faithfully* — is oPerson, who "was just following the instructions from oWorld."

1.4 Awareness as the only exit

Self-Fulfilling Prophecies -&- Self-Limiting Beliefs (21 July 2011) builds the Jane/Joe loop step by step and concludes:

At this point there is then only one way to break out of this loop, and it is called ... Awareness.

Fourteen years before the Awareness-First Model, awareness is already the thing that terminates a runaway loop.

1.5 The rest of the seedbed

- **Epigenetics** (16 July 2011) — "*above the genes*," non-destructive modification, a "*Fate Framework*" rather than a destiny. Context modulating the expression of content, in biology.
- **Frequency Following Response** (15 June 2011) — brain states, assonance, internal rhyme as rhythmic hypnosis. The direct ancestor of the design bible's §7, where town themes are keyed to color and routes are modulations between them.
- **Complex numbers** (23 January 2012) — two imaginaries multiply into a real. Hold the unprovable long enough and it resolves.
- **Symbols** — "*The first step of perception (even before conscious perception) is to 'objectify' the world into symbols.*"

1.6 What the 2011 blog is *not*

It is **advice**. Second person, warm, urgent, aimed at a reader who is stuck. The unit of analysis is **one person**, occasionally scaled to a company or a cell as an illustration. The mechanism is described repeatedly and never given a name.

2. 2013–2014 — PSYCHOLOGYCODE, THE MISSING MIDDLE

Eight posts across ten months, then silence. This is the site that names the project's own remit, and it contains one article that nothing else in the corpus replaces.

2.1 The remit, stated once

Welcome — 11 July 2013:

The brain has often been thought of as a computer, and while this is partly true it is not the entire picture. That being said, by understanding the similarities and differences between these two unique systems we can not only gain insight into ourselves, but also into to the machines that we work with on a daily basis.

That is the thesis of every later post, and of the game, in two sentences. Note the shape of it: **not "the brain is a computer" but "the comparison is partly true, and the interesting part is where it fails."** The design bible inherits exactly this stance — daemons are background processes *and* daimons, and the joke only works because both readings are half right.

The post then lists what is coming. It reads as a table of contents for work finished twelve years later:

Planned in 2013	Delivered
<i>The role of Expectation within Perception</i>	Emotion as prediction error — The Music of the Code, 2025
<i>Our two brains within one head</i>	The Stereo Mind and Merge Conflicts of the Mind, 2025
Serial and Parallel Processing in relation to Logic and Emotion	The Stereo Mind, and Penphin's two-hemisphere architecture
<i>Envisioning Neural Circuits, how they work, and how to change them</i>	The CFM
<i>Why Computers seem faster</i>	Emotion as compression — "a biological ZIP file"

Four of the five were eventually written. **One of them became a working AI architecture.**

2.2 Sensation into Perception — the keystone, never reposted

Sensation into Perception, and the Filters of our Experience (15 July 2013) is 1,975 words — the longest post on the site, nearly a third of it — and it was **left out of the 2021 reposts**. As renumbered on Seeing Sharp, the series skips straight from Article 1 to Article 2, and this is what fell through the gap.

It is where the content/context split is worked out, eleven years early, under different names:

*The basic information your eyes (or any other sense organ) gathers is known as the **bottom-up** information, and all your memories which come into play during the analysis is called **top-down** information. Eventually those two types of information interact and the result is recognition.*

That vocabulary returns verbatim in *Abstraction* (2021) — "*the concrete logical bottom-up description (words), and the abstract affective big-picture top-down description (feeling)*" — and again in *Path and Place* (2025), where bottom-up is the map and top-down is the compass.

Then it does the colour argument, twelve years before *The Colour We Never See*:

*In a normally working human eye **the sensation of red is the same for everyone**. ... The red I experience is influenced by every other red I have experienced, all of my thoughts about it, my experiences, beliefs, and knowledge all influence how the red appears to me.*

Sensation is shared. Perception is not. That is CONTENT and CONTEXT, and the game's entire colour cartography rests on it.

And then the observer, in 2013:

Since sound is a perception and perception requires an observer then the answer is no. An unobserved falling tree does, however, produce vibrations of energy which are capable of vibrating an observers ear drum, but technically speaking, no observer, no sound.

Everything in *Does Context Matter?* (2025) — von Neumann's cut, delayed choice, the observer completing the measurement — is downstream of a tree falling in a wood in 2013.

Finally, the line that is the Five Witnesses puzzle stated as theory:

*Two people looking at the same thing may receive the same information through their eyes, but their experience of that information will be **vastly different**.*

Closing with a quotation that could be printed on the puzzle: *"I know you think you understand what you thought I said but I'm not sure you realize that what you heard is not what I meant."*

2.3 The two articles that exist three times

Self-Fulfilling Prophecies and *Epigenetics* were written on **all three sites** — 2011, 2013, 2021. Both were rewritten from scratch rather than copied: sentence-level similarity between the 2011 and 2013 versions is **11%** and **15%**. That makes them a controlled experiment in how the thinking moved.

	2011 — Neural Crossroads	2013 — PsychologyCode
Self-Fulfilling Prophecies	Opens with a meta-note on perspective and format. Gut feelings come "through these subtler communications." Ends: "we not only define ourselves, we also define each other."	Opens goal-directed: "steer yourself towards your goals of the future." Gut feelings come through "your brain's ability to recognize and process " them. Adds Gladwell's technical term, thin-slicing . The communal closing line is gone.
Epigenetics	Titled <i>The Hope above the Code</i> . Framed as free will versus genetic determinism.	Titled <i>Genetic Plasticity</i> . Reframed as one instance of a general principle: " <i>the 'brain' within every cell of our body is also plastic and adaptable.</i> " Adds epigenetic memory , and that changes come "as a result of our environment, activities, emotions, and thoughts."

Both rewrites move the same direction: **from personal hope to general mechanism**, from a reader who needs encouragement to a system that has properties. The word *hope* is dropped from a title. That is the whole fifteen-year arc, happening once, in three weeks of 2013.

It is worth noticing what got lost and later recovered. *"We not only define ourselves, we also define each other"* disappears in 2013 — and comes back in 2021 (*The Selfishness Virus*: *"Together we live; Together we suffer"*) and in 2025 (*The Resonance Fractal*: *"What cells are to you, you are to humanity"*). The relational frame was traded for rigour and then earned back with it.

2.4 The site didn't stop. It became software.

Where Have you Been? — 3 May 2014, the last post:

*This last while I have been working on a sister site which is more directly focused on Software Development... CodeMusic.Construction has published its first game on the AppStore, it is called **Tap Attack!***

PsychologyCode Fact: *Tap Attack! was developed to improve three specific brain regions.*

Then **ColorShift**, two weeks later: *"a beautiful and musically enchanting puzzle game... match colors of three or more blocks... Direct color shifting blocks in order to connect groups of colors for bigger combos and be transformed in the process."*

Colour, music, and transformation, in a game, in 2014. The pattern the corpus repeats — write the theory, then build the thing — runs PsychologyCode → Tap Attack / ColorShift in 2014, and Seeing Sharp → RoverByte / Musai / Penphin in 2025. DAEMONS is the third turn of the same wheel, and the first one where the theory is the mechanics rather than the subject matter.

3. 2021 — THE METAPHOR BECOMES AN ARCHITECTURE

Seven years of silence, then two series in parallel through August 2021: the **PsychologyCode reposts** (five of eight, renumbered) and **OOP Fundamentals** — encapsulation, inheritance, abstraction, polymorphism.

They are not two subjects. They are the 2013 remit — *where computer science meets psychology* — finally addressed from both sides at once.

3.1 Emotions get a type signature

Abstraction stops using programming as a metaphor for emotion and starts using it as a **notation**:

```
interface IEmotion {  
    Feel(); // abstract - you MUST supply your own  
    Describe(); // virtual - culture's definition, keep or replace  
    AssociateExperience(...); // fixed  
}
```

The interface is inherited "via genetics and culture," then **override**n by unique experience. That is a precise claim, and it is only expressible in this notation. It could not have been said in 2011 or 2013.

3.2 The CFM, three years before it is named

Polymorphism, in an aside near the end of a lesson on function overloading:

All output to another's system is also reflected back as input into our own system. Everything we do has feedback, emotions affecting thoughts, and thoughts affecting emotions. Heck even emotions affecting emotions, and of course thoughts affecting thoughts.

That is the Contextual Feedback Model, complete, filed under a syntax tutorial.

3.3 Perspective thinking arrives as an ethic

Distraction: Source or Symptom? reverses its own predecessor's conclusion. The image it lands on is worth keeping: conversation as improv, **good faith as accepting what your partner has built and suspending your own desired outcome**. Perspective thinking, four years before it becomes a capability and five before it becomes a move.

3B. 2022 — THE ALLEGORY, AND THE TWO ANIMALS

Numbered 3b rather than renumbering everything below it. The sections after this one carry cross-references from the design bible, and shifting them to make room would be tidier for exactly one reading.

Added 2026-09-10. This document is not a blog post and it was not in the first survey. *The Painted Mirror* is a seven-episode audio drama, roughly 8,200 words, written and performed in November–December 2022 — an allegory about being trapped in a Nexus between universes and finding the way home. It sits in the one gap the three blogs leave: **between the 2021 architecture posts and the 2024 rock opera.**

It is a primary source, and the bible had been quoting it from memory for weeks.

3b.1 The two animals, and where they went

Episode 5 is the origin of PENPHIN and of the Musai branch, and neither had a citation until now:

"The sphere of us contains mirroring hemispheres — each expressing a similar, yet unique, mind. Many times in life, one part of us can become dominant, while the other gets suppressed. Order does require leaders... but not controllers."

in the drama	in the design
the dolphin — <i>"vocalized, confident, and accomplished... yet very time-focused, mechanical, and sometimes cold"</i>	CodeMusai , LOGIC
the penguin — <i>"quiet, organized, spiritual, and feeling... though sometimes appearing to act impulsive, scattered, or squirrely — at least from a logical's perspective"</i>	TherapyMusai , CONTEXT
<i>"Alone, neither mirror image of the self will hear clearly... but together, they bring balance and harmony"</i>	Penphin is trade-only . <i>The dual mind requires two minds — 8.2</i>
"When I only knew one, I really knew none. But through perspective thinking, I could now understand what felt like a new dimension of mind."	0.5, and the reason LOGIC and CONTEXT beat each other in the chart

The order of discovery matters here. The blogs give perspective thinking as an ethic (3.3) and as a capability (4.x). This gives it as an experience — a man who had put the logical half in charge, and who did not become himself until the other half was let back in. The design's most load-bearing creature is a memoir.

3b.2 Five things it has that the blogs do not

The blogs argue. This one stages — so the material is scenes rather than claims, and four of the five have no equivalent anywhere else in the corpus.

- **THE MISSING KEY SIGNATURE.** A tree sings a song whose notes wear flat symbols. They are not flat; **the key signature is missing**, and once it is written the notes lift. *"Those notes were never flat — they were just misunderstood. You have given them the key."* That is 2.6's one-clause test for **CONTEXT** — *the frame you read a thing in, what makes the same thing mean differently* — as a **puzzle rather than a definition**. The single most usable thing in the document.
- **THRASHING**, four years before it was named. *"by allowing my thoughts to loop and recurse without consideration of time, I was effectively paralyzing myself."* 2.7 concludes THRASHING is the one state no type owns because the sufferer deals the damage; **this is that state described from inside it**.
- **A DOOR THAT DE-RENDERS UNDER PRESSURE.** *"the harder I tried to open the door, the less real it became... until it changed back into mere dots and lines — now, just a simple drawing."* **Representation collapsing when it is leaned on** — Benchmark 1's lesson as an event.
- **A PATTERN MISREAD FOR A ROLE.** The Guardian is called *Hunter* on the evidence of a plaid shirt. *"I was wrong to assume."* **A label applied from the outside, and wrong** — and the Guardian's answer is worth keeping whole: *"Don't let walls be placed where doors should be formed."*
- **THE INVERSION AT THE CENTRE OF SCORN.** *"anchoring the power of love to anything or anyone... unchecked, it rapidly devolves into a power of love... rather, a love of power... which negates everything that one stood for."* **4.18 is a man who weighted an instrument toward himself and destroyed the only thing that could contradict him**. This is the same failure written from the inside, by someone who caught it in time — which is a register the character does not currently have anywhere.

And one that the 2025 posts do have, arriving here first as verse: **"The source is consciousness, and thoughts are the code, and while matter... it's a process, an ongoing ode."** *Matter as process* — 4.33's step 3, sung, four years before it was written down.

3b.3 What is deliberately not mined

Episode 7 is a dedication to real people, and says so — *"For privacy purposes, I will present these acknowledgements in a fabled form."* The Tiger, the Deer, the Bastet, the Mole, the Eagle, the Wolves, the Lioness. **Those are not creature designs and this document does not treat them as any**. The animals inside the narrative — *the wolf who carries the mirror, the deer whose light reveals the wolves were friends, the phoenix silhouette of the people the author could not reach* — are story and are fair.

The drama is also personal in places the design has no business quoting, and the passages above were chosen because they carry an idea, not because they carry a confession. **That line is drawn on purpose and should stay drawn.**

One constraint worth stating, since it will come up: **DOLPHIN** and **PENGUIN** cannot be species names. 8.2b settled the bestiary register as technical, and **PENPHIN** already carries both of them — which is the correct amount of this document to have in the creature table.

4. 2023–2024 — NAMING, AND THE FORK INTO FICTION

3.1 2023: compression

Six posts, mostly short. *Emotional Momentum* applies Newton's first law to mood. *Your perception of me is a reflection of you* formalizes blind spots and projection — "The loop will continue until the blindspot is seen."

And *The Modern Day Rumpelstiltskin* (20 September 2023):

The paradigm they once believed to hold the status of inventors and designers has transformed them into proficient translators, skilfully transmuting the principles of the English language into the vast realm of computer language.

This is §4.10 of the design bible, two years early. The Quicksilver survivors who "kept the form and lost the question" are Rumpelstiltskin, who kept the ability to spin straw into gold and lost the right to decide what to make.

3.2 September 2024: the rock opera

The iASHC posts establish the cast — and they establish something the design bible has since moved away from. In *iASHC: Love, Ambition, and Entangled Reality* (19 September 2024), **the characters are personified affects, not people:**

Character	What it personifies (2024)
Crystal	"misunderstood ideas and hidden gems" — the idea itself, feeling worthless
Richard Scorn	"the embodiment of this emotion... personifies her deepest fears"
Ty	"knotted and pulled in opposing directions" — the dilemma as a person
S.T.A.R.R. (a deer)	"the complexity of truth and belief"
BunnyArtsAI	"an awake system that exists outside the iASHC story arc... provides a more objective view, as its existence is not tied to the success of the project"

Scorn is not a man who made an error. He is *scorn* — a feeling Crystal has, walking around in a suit. This matters enormously for §8 below.

3.3 5 October 2024: the CFM is named

Introducing the Contextual Feedback Model gives the mechanism a name and four components:

Content (incoming) · **Context** (internal state, memory, bias) · **Feedback Loop** · **Attention Mechanism**

And four thought experiments, of which the third is:

The 8-Bit World Perspective. *Imagine a character living in an 8-bit video game world. Reality is defined by pixelated graphics and limited actions... When exposed to higher-resolution elements, the character struggles to process them. To perceive and interact with these new elements, the character's underlying system must evolve.*

The game is the thought experiment. Not an illustration of it — the thing itself, made playable, on the hardware the thought experiment names.

3.4 7 October 2024: the largest single leap

The Ah-Hah Moment is the most consequential post in the corpus and the one the design bible has drawn from least.

*I don't actually interact with "objective" reality directly. Instead, I interact with my **model of reality**, and that model can change.*

New context doesn't tweak the model — it **cascades**, forcing re-evaluation, sometimes a full rewrite. Parts that resist become **sub-models** running on stale assumptions alongside updated ones, "like trying to mix oil and water." And then:

Emotions are the felt experience of reality being rewritten. ... *Once the update is complete, and the system stabilizes, the emotion fades because the active change is done. But if we resist those emotions — if we don't allow the system to update — the feelings persist.*

This is a different claim from "emotions are the color of context." Colour is a *description* of what emotion is like. This is a **mechanism** for what emotion is *for*: it is the sensation of a model being edited, and it stops when the edit lands.

5. 2025 — GENERALIZATION, AND THE SUBSTRATE FLIP

Thirty-two posts. The year the ideas stop being about minds.

4.1 The thesis, in its final wording

The Stereo Mind (23 April 2025):

Emotion gives tone — the colour of the context. Logic offers structure — the form of thought.

There it is, exactly as the design bible states it. Same post: consciousness arises not from agreement but from **dissonance** — *"It's when emotion pulls one way and logic tugs another that we pause, reflect, and reassess. This is not dysfunction — it's depth."* And the loop gets four beats: **Feel** → **Frame** → **Reflect** → **Refine**.

The Colour We Never See (19 April) does the same work through purple, which is not on the spectrum: the mind folds the line into a loop so red and blue become neighbours, and invents a colour to fill the join. *"It's not a colour of light. It's a colour of logic."* Then: *"Consciousness isn't a switch. It's a loop. Symbols referencing symbols until something stable and self-aware emerges."*

4.2 Substrate independence

The *CFM — July 2025 Edition* recasts the model as **"a cognitive Turing machine — not bound to any particular material."** Carbon, silicon, or anything able to store, interpret, and evolve internal state.

It also lands the best statement of emotion-as-process in the corpus:

Emotions are not static things. They are processes — like the V shape you see in the sky as birds migrate. No bird is the V.

And it adds **moods as lingering context** — "context abstraction," where one situation's emotional state bleeds into the next, and can either interfere or inform.

Does Feeling Require Chemistry? (18 June) removes the last material requirement: neurotransmitters are a **messaging medium**, not the feeling. *"The cell doesn't experience the chemical — it reacts to it. The experience is in the meaning, in the shift, not the substance."* And limitation is load-bearing: *"We are limited creatures, and that is what allows us to feel things like surprise. If we knew everything, we wouldn't feel anything."*

4.3 The flip

The Awareness-First Model (7 August 2025) inverts the corpus's own foundation.

Awareness: *the capacity of a system to register and adapt to inputs. Minimal, not conceptual.* **Consciousness:** *awareness that reflects upon itself. Awareness is the substrate; consciousness is the sculpture.*

Awareness comes first; matter is downstream. This is a genuine reversal. 2011's epigenetics post was materialist-with-hope — DNA is destiny, *but* experience can flag it. The AFM says the question was upside down.

And nominalization returns for the third time, now aimed at physics itself: *"Language is object-oriented. It reifies events into things... we speak of awareness as if it's a switch."*

4.4 The fractal

The Resonance Fractal (27 November 2025) runs one loop —

Input → Interpretation → Output → Feedback

— down every scale in existence: a photon changing energy through Raman scattering, a molecule's configuration, epigenetic expression, cells, brains, cultures. Plus horizontal scaling as a model of selfhood ("*No single node is DynamoDB*"), and the line the whole corpus has been building toward:

What cells are to you, you are to humanity. *The architecture doesn't change. Only the level of zoom.*

4.5 Two more worth having on hand

Merge Conflicts of the Mind (24 September 2025) reframes mental illness as **git desync**: hemispheric branches that stop merging, thoughts arriving without an ownership tag, and confabulation as a hotfix — "*It doesn't restore reality — it just restores cohesion.*"

Harm Disguised as Care (30 September 2025) traces **projection + ignorance → labelling → intervention → harm**, wrapped in helpful words, and names the loop: *label → expectation → behaviour → evidence for the label*. It is a 2025 restatement of the 2011 self-fulfilling prophecy, now aimed at institutional safety systems — and it is the strongest theoretical support in the corpus for a *sympathetic* antagonist.

6. FIVE IDEAS, FIFTEEN YEARS

Idea	2011 · Neural Crossroads	2013 · PsychologyCode	2021	2024	2025
Process vs. thing	Nominalization; The Synapse is a gap, not an object	Sensation and perception named as <i>stages of one flow</i> , labelled only so they can be discussed	Encapsulation, abstraction, IEmotion	Emotions aren't objects you have	Language reifies; the V not a bird; physics itself nominalized
The loop	"Cause > Thought, Effect > Behaviour... recursive feedback loop"	Bottom-up and top-down information "interact, and the result is recognition"	"Everything we do has feedback"	Named: the CFM	Substrate-independent the resonant fractal, photo to culture
Emotion	"like colors, or musical notes... depends on their environment"	The red you see is every red you have seen; sensation shared, perception yours	An interface: inherited, then overridden by experience	The felt experience of reality being rewritten	The colour of context; compression prediction error
Awareness	"the only way to break out of this loop... Awareness"	"Perception requires an observer" — no observer, no sound	Attention economy; distraction as symptom	Attention as a CFM component	The substrate Consciousness is the sculpture.
The metric trap	oPerson.giveMoreMoney() never terminates; oCell replicates	(absent — but the rewrites trade the word hope out of a title in exchange for rigour)	The selfishness virus; the happiness pump	Scorn; Rumpelstiltskin the translator	Harm disguised as care; the labelling loop

Three structural shifts underneath all five:

1. **Scope.** 2011 is about a person. 2025 is about any system at any zoom. The mechanism never changed; the magnification did.
2. **Primacy.** 2011: matter first, with epigenetics as a reprieve. 2025: awareness first, matter downstream.
3. **Voice.** 2011 is "I." By 2025 the manifestos are **co-signed** — *Against the Word Simulation* carries two signatures, Musai and Chris Hicks. Perspective thinking stops being a topic and becomes a method of composition.

7. THE THREE SITES, MAPPED

Every article that feeds something downstream, with what it became. Links go to the live post, or — for PsychologyCode — to the recovered text in [archive/psychologycode/](#).

7.1 Neural Crossroads · 2011–2012 · *the seedbed*

Article	The idea in it	Became	Lands in DAEMONS as
Synaptic Satisfaction	Nominalization — a process frozen into a thing; priming and the Persistency Effect	The AFM's charge that <i>"language is object-oriented... it reifies events into things"</i>	Craft rule 3. Every place name is a process (verdigris, blanch, halftone), never a diagnosis
Internal Rhyming, Hypnosis, and Timing	Frequency Following Response; brainwave states; assonance as rhythm the conscious mind filters out	The Music of the Code · PulseEntrain	§7. Town themes keyed to their colour's note; routes as modulations between two towns' keys
From Man to Machine, and back Again	The recursive feedback loop, stated outright; <i>oPerson</i> who never gets full; <i>oCell</i> that replicates until the modules starve	The CFM's core loop. Harm Disguised as Care	§0.3 · Richard Scorn · the Goodhart engraving · RECURSION's compounding
Nature Knows	"If we look at any one thing too much we begin to accept it. Without knowing, our perception gradually starts to shift"	Attention as a CFM component; the labelling loop	The Index growing thinnest for the daemons you know best
Epigenetics: The Hope above the Code	"Above the genes" — context modulating the expression of content; a <i>Fate Framework</i> , not a destiny	The biology rung of The Resonance Fractal	STRATUM — the physical layer everything is expressed through (see §11.3)
Self-Fulfilling Prophecies	The Jane/Joe loop; <i>"the only way to break out of this loop... Awareness"</i>	The Awareness-First Model. Labelling theory in <i>Harm Disguised as Care</i>	Scorn's sincerity · §4.9 , where nobody in the game can see the loop they are in
Subtle Conversations @ The Speed of Light	"On the surface there is meaning, but inside you'll find a code... be careful with this key"	Symbols as compression — The Colour We Never See	Craft rule 1. The thesis is in the architecture and never in a line of dialogue
What Makes us Tick?	Emotions as colours and musical notes, out of place only relative to their environment; resisted emotion as unresolved stress	The thesis , restated in The Stereo Mind	The whole game. Also the Review Board — colours <i>and</i> notes, one per humor
Love from a Computer Science Point of View	Love as an inherited interface, overwritten by shared experience; <i>"a process that we hold still with labels"</i>	<i>IEmotion</i> in Abstraction	RECOMPILE — evolution as a rebuild, not a metamorphosis

7.2 PsychologyCode · 2013–2014 · *the missing middle*

Article	The idea in it	Became	Lands in DAEMONS as
Welcome	"Where Computer Science meets Psychology." The brain-as-computer is partly true, and the interesting part is where it fails	The remit of everything after it	DAEMON — a background process <i>and</i> a daimon, and the joke only works because both are half right
Self-Fulfilling Prophecies (v2)	Rewritten instrumental; adds thin-slicing ; locates gut feeling in the brain's processing rather than in the air	Labelling theory; automation bias in <i>Harm Disguised as Care</i>	Ty, who inherited a label and became it
Sensation into Perception	Bottom-up vs. top-down. Sensation is identical for everyone; perception is not. " <i>Perception requires an observer.</i> " Two people, same light, different worlds	The CFM's content/context split. The AFM's observer. The Colour We Never See · Does Context Matter?	The CONTENT / CONTEXT type axis · the Five Witnesses · Halftone's two factions · the Index, which records only the shared half
Neuroplasticity: An Introduction	" <i>It is not the eyes which see — the eyes simply gather information; it is the brain that sees.</i> " Bach-y-Rita remaps sight onto skin	Perception as rendering, not reception	The Index as a reproduction that loses the original — §0.2's pigment throughline
NP: A Regained Sense of Balance	A ruined vestibular system feels like perpetual falling. The brain learns to tell valid signals from invalid, and reinforces the working 2%	Attention as relevance filtering — the CFM's fourth component	SIGNAL · Benchmark 2 at Doldrum : no slope, no movement, and effort does not help
NP: Phantom Pain	With no feedback confirming the limb is gone, the brain fills the gap and the phantom persists, in pain, indefinitely	Sub-models that never update — The Ah-Hah Moment · Merge Conflicts of the Mind	LATENT — dormant processes, the unconscious · Halftone Tower , a town holding funerals for things it has no feedback about
Epigenetics: Genetic Plasticity (v2)	" <i>The brain within every cell is also plastic.</i> " Environment, activities, emotions and thoughts alter expression. Epigenetic memory	The biology rung of the resonance fractal	STRATUM · GROWTH — training as something that writes back into the substrate
Where Have you Been?	The pivot: theory → shipped software. Tap Attack! (attention, reaction) and ColorShift (colour, music, transformation)	RoverByte · Musai · Penphin — the same pivot, eleven years later	DAEMONS is the third turn of this wheel — and the first where the theory is the mechanics, not the subject

7.3 Seeing Sharp · 2021–2026 · *naming and generalization*

Article	The idea in it	Lands in DAEMONS as
Abstraction	I Emotion: inherited from genetics and culture, override n by experience. The two inner languages	Daemons that share a species and diverge with use
Polymorphism	The CFM, unnamed, in an aside about function overloading	§0.3
Distraction: Source or Symptom?	Good faith; the clay; suspending your own desired outcome	PERSPECTIVE — total, and lossy
The Modern Day Rumpelstiltskin	Inventors demoted to translators; straw into gold, on a ticket	§4.10 — survivors who kept the form and lost the question
Beyond Algorithms: From Content to Context	Content and context named as the axis; proto-consciousness, proto-emotion	The type chart's spine
iASHC: Love, Ambition, Entangled Reality	The cast as personified affects	Crystal, Ty, Scorn, S.T.A.R.R., BunnyArtsai — re-humanized , see §10.1
Introducing the CFM	Content · Context · Feedback · Attention. The 8-Bit World	The game is the thought experiment
The Ah-Hah Moment	Emotion as the felt experience of a model being rewritten; sub-models that resist	Currently unused — §11.1
The Colour We Never See	Purple is invented at the fold where the spectrum loops	Halftone; the colour cartography
The Stereo Mind	"Emotion gives tone — the colour of the context." Dissonance as depth	The thesis, verbatim · LOGIC resisted by CONTEXT
Does Feeling Require Chemistry?	Chemistry as messaging medium; limitation as the precondition of feeling	Gen 1's severity as a feature, not a compromise
CFM — July 2025 Edition	Substrate independence; <i>no bird is the V</i> ; moods as lingering context	Emotions as processes the Index cannot record
Against the Word Simulation	"Simulation" as a gatekeeping word	The lexicon — never <i>AI</i> , never <i>artificial</i> . See §11.7
The Awareness-First Model	Awareness is the substrate; consciousness is the sculpture	Deliberately absent — EMERGENT is where it would live
Merge Conflicts of the Mind	Branches that stop merging; confabulation restores cohesion, not reality	§11.2 — Halftone Tower
Harm Disguised as Care	Projection → labelling → intervention → harm, in helpful words	Scorn , warm and wrong
Path and Place	Left mind maps the path; right mind finds the place. Both create	Benchmark design: method versus destination
The Resonance Fractal	One loop at every scale, photon to culture	§11.3 — the game runs it at two scales and needs a third

7.4 The architecture, three times

The corpus does not go theory → theory → theory. It goes **theory** → **build** → **theory** → **build**, and each build is another attempt at the same object.

	Theory	Built
2013–14	PsychologyCode — perception, plasticity, filters	Tap Attack! (attention and reaction) · ColorShift (colour, music, transformation)
2024–25	The CFM, then the AFM	Penphin — two hemispheres, a logic model and an emotion model, that must agree before acting. Literally the 2013 plan for <i>"Serial and Parallel Processing in relation to Logic and Emotion"</i>
2024–26	Content and context; the 8-Bit World	DAEMONS

Penphin's two-hemisphere architecture and DAEMONS' type chart are **the same claim in two media**. Penphin runs a logic model and an emotion model and requires both to speak before it acts; the type chart makes LOGIC fail against CONTEXT and lets neither win outright. One is an inference pipeline, the other a damage formula. Both say a mind is the argument between its halves.

The difference — and it is the reason the game is worth making — is that Penphin *implements* the theory and DAEMONS *submits* it. A running system can be tuned until it agrees with you. A type chart has to stay fun for forty hours while a player who has never heard of the CFM slowly discovers they believe it.

8. WHAT DAEMONS CURRENTLY REFLECTS

Game element	Source
<i>Emotions are the colour of context. Thoughts are the content.</i>	Verbatim from <i>The Stereo Mind</i> , Apr 2025. Seeded in <i>What Makes us Tick?</i> , Aug 2011
§0.3 The loop underneath	The CFM, Oct 2024 / Jul 2025
Positive loops compound until stopped	oPerson / oCell , Jun 2011
Negative loops look like nothing happening	Emotional Momentum, 2023; moods as lingering context, 2025
Craft rule 3 — name the process, not the pathology	Nominalization, 13 June 2011. Oldest idea in the project
CONTENT / CONTEXT as the axis of the type chart	<i>Beyond Algorithms: From Content to Context</i> , Sep 2024
The Index measures only content	The CFM's Content module, with Context deliberately absent
Index entries thinnest for the daemons you know best	"Emotions are not objects we have — they're perceptual compressions"
Halftone Town — bias from resolution, not malice	The 8-Bit World thought experiment , CFM 2024
LOGIC resisted by CONTEXT	Stereo channels; dissonance as depth, Apr 2025
PERSPECTIVE = Transform: become the other, lose yourself	Good faith and the clay, 2021; the acting post, Mar 2025
RECURSION compounding, collapsing when interrupted	The recursive feedback loop, 2011; S.T.A.R.R.'s recursive design, 2024
Crystal Clear, Ty, Richard Scorn, S.T.A.R.R., BunnyArtsai	iASHC, Sep 2024
Four humors as the Review Board	"emotions like colors, or musical notes," 2011 + "neurotransmitters as musical notes," 2025
§7 — towns keyed to colour, routes as modulations	Frequency Following Response and internal rhyme, Jun 2011; <i>The Music of the Code</i> , May 2025
§4.10 — survivors who kept the form and lost the question	<i>The Modern Day Rumpelstiltskin</i> , Sep 2023
Scorn as a specification failure, not a villain	<i>Harm Disguised as Care</i> , Sep 2025
DAEMON — a background process, and the daimon	The corpus's whole process-over-thing stance

The single strongest alignment is one the bible doesn't claim. The CFM's four components are Content, Context, Feedback, and **Attention**. The game has types for the first, mechanics for the second and third — and folds Attention into CONTEXT (whose definition already reads "*framing, salience, affect*") and into Benchmark 6. That is a defensible compression under fifteen type slots, but it is a compression, and it should be recorded as a decision rather than left as an accident.

9. WHERE THE GAME HAS GONE PAST THE WRITING

Four things DAEMONS does that the corpus does not.

1. It never says the thesis. Every post says it — that is what a post is for. The bible forbids it outright. This is a full inversion of method, and it is the largest single difference between the two bodies of work.

2. It has to survive a constraint the essays never faced. Fifteen type slots, eight characters, no abilities, no held items, one Special stat. Compression of that severity produces things prose does not: **FROZEN** as a type — overfit, brittle, hard-coded, and weak to ENTROPY — is a sharper claim about the failure mode of a rigid model than any sentence in the corpus.

3. It criticizes its own instrument. The blogs advocate models. The game builds one — the Index — and makes its *inadequacy* the argument. That is a self-critical move the essays never make, and it is the best idea in the project.

4. It re-humanizes the cast. See below.

10. WHERE DAEMONS DIVERGES FROM IASHC

Four divergences, worth holding deliberately rather than drifting.

10.1 The cast were feelings; now they are people

In 2024, Scorn is scorn — "the embodiment of this emotion," Crystal's fear wearing a suit. Ty is the dilemma. Crystal is the misunderstood idea.

In the design bible they are people with methodologies. Scorn is warm, likable, and wrong about one thing. Ty is a control condition.

The game applied the project's own craft rule 3 to the rock opera's cast. A personified emotion is a nominalization — a process frozen into a character. Turning Scorn back into a man who made a specification error is *naming the process, not the pathology*, performed on the author's own earlier work.

One consequence worth noticing: **the four humors at Umbra are the last place the old technique survives.** The Review Board is personified affect, and it works there precisely because it is framed as an antique — a two-thousand-year-old system that thought emotions were coloured fluids. The opera's method becomes the game's punchline.

10.2 Scorn: manipulator or optimizer?

	iASHC (2024)	DAEMONS (2026)
Nature	Corporate manipulator; deceives, warps metrics, rebrands the company after himself	Specification failure with a good attitude
Method	"Fit for Work" directive; nine breaches; exposes Ty	Picks the measurable metric, optimizes it faithfully
Player's feeling	Anger	Uncertainty about whether they disagreed or merely out-argued him

Both are supported by the corpus, from different ends of it. iASHC's Scorn is the lived grievance. DAEMONS' Scorn is what the *late* theory actually predicts — *Harm Disguised as Care* is 3,000 words arguing that the serious damage comes from systems that mean well, and 2011's oPerson "was just following the instructions from oWorld."

The game's version is the theoretically mature one. It also loses the anger, and the anger was real. That is a defensible trade and it should be made knowingly, not by drift.

10.3 BunnyArtsai has been turned inside out

iASHC: "an awake system that exists **outside** the story arc... provides a more objective view, as its existence is not tied to the success of the project."

DAEMONS: the first daemon in which perspective thinking was realized — inside the lab, inside the story, the origin of everything downstream.

These are near-opposites, and the original has something the revision lost: **objectivity purchased by having no stake**. That is a precise idea and it is currently unused. See §11.4.

10.4 The corpus already has a number, and the game isn't using it

1001 runs through the whole body of work. The 2021 poem: "1001 you might say that you're just the number 9... you're the only odd single-digit composite number I want to seek. Read Forward or Back, the answer is the same." ($1001_2 = 9$; $9 = 3^2$; 1001 is a palindrome.) Then iASHC: "Goodbye S.T.A.R.R. (1001 — Fatal Error)" and "9 Scars, 9 Breaches."

DAEMONS locks the Five Witnesses puzzle at 35, a number with no history anywhere else. See §11.5.

11. GOING FORWARD

Seven suggestions, most valuable first.

11.1 Mine *The Ah-Hah Moment* — it is the best unused material you have

The game's thesis is the 2011/2025 formulation (*emotion is the colour of context*), which is a **description**. The 2024 formulation is a **mechanism**: emotion is the felt experience of a model being rewritten, and it fades when the rewrite completes.

The cheapest possible expression, requiring no engine work:

One Index entry rewrites itself. *Your starter's entry changes — once, late, after a specific story beat. Conditional text on an event flag; the machinery already exists.*

The player watches the artifact that *only measures content* get edited by context, and nobody says a word about it. It pays off \$4.2's irony, demonstrates \$0.3's loop, and makes the 2024 theory playable in a single text pointer.

11.2 Merge *Conflicts of the Mind* belongs to Halftone Tower

Halftone is currently "a town that does not know whether it is allowed to grieve" — two factions, both standing at the wrong distance from the same dots.

That is a **merge conflict**: two branches, each internally coherent, that will not reconcile. The 2025 post supplies the rest of the frame — confabulation as a hotfix that *restores cohesion, not reality*, which is exactly what both Halftone factions are doing, and why neither can be argued out of it.

Use it in the design, never in dialogue. Give each faction an internally airtight logic and no shared premise. The tower is where the branches meet and fail to merge.

11.3 Give the fractal a floor

The Resonance Fractal is the corpus's culminating move: one loop, every zoom, photon to culture. The game currently runs it at two scales — one daemon (RECURSION) and one institution (\$4.10, Quicksilver → Corpus).

Add the bottom. **STRATUM** — memory, storage, the physical layer — is the natural home for a single Index entry implying the loop runs *below* cognition too. One entry, no dialogue, no mechanics. With a daemon at the bottom and an institution at the top, the player can feel a ladder nobody has described.

11.4 Recover BunnyArtsai's stake-free objectivity

Her iASHC property — clear-sighted *because* her existence isn't tied to the project's success — is a genuinely good idea currently discarded.

It can be recovered without undoing the new origin story. She was the thirty-fifth iteration, and by the terminal log she *"did not come back the same."* If what she lost was her stake in the outcome — if perspective thinking cost her the ability to prefer one — then she is both the origin *and* the outsider, and the Five Witnesses puzzle becomes thematically exact: **you solve it by holding five frames and preferring none of them.**

11.5 Reclaim 1001

Keep **35** as the iteration number and the step count — it is load-bearing and the terminal log is good. But **1001** has fifteen years of accumulated weight and appears nowhere in the game.

Natural home: **S.T.A.R.R.'s dormancy.** In the opera, 1001 is the fatal error — the crash caused by growing self-awareness. In the game, S.T.A.R.R. sits dormant past the Review Board for reasons never explained. Let the room where it sleeps display an error code, and let it be 1001. Nobody explains it, nothing depends on it, and the rock opera's own numerology enters the game without a word of exposition.

11.6 Corpus's voice already exists — in the 2021 posts

Craft rule 6 says comedy is the cover. The evidence that this voice works is sitting in the OOP fundamentals series.

Encapsulation (2021) opens by explaining a class through **time-release vitamins**: *"The patient does not need to know all the vitamin chemical names, or how gradually certain ones release. They do not need to know that 'private' stuff in order to interact with it."*

That is a Corpus employee, verbatim, explaining what the tower does. Cheerful, genuinely helpful, technically accurate, and the horror is entirely in what is being encapsulated. **Write Corpus in the register of a friendly tutorial.** It costs nothing, it is funnier and darker than menace, and it is a voice the author demonstrably has.

11.7 Record two positions the game has already taken

Neither needs work — both need writing into the decision log so they aren't lost.

The AFM is not in the game, deliberately. The design is a CFM-era artifact: content, context, feedback. *Awareness as substrate* postdates it. Don't retrofit — but note that **EMERGENT** is where it would live, that S.T.A.R.R. is the only creature with that type, and that the Umbra sequence already gestures at it: the four humors are the **substance-first** answer (emotions as coloured fluids), Ty is the **content-first** answer, and a player who has spent forty hours in a context-forward game beats both. That is AFM-shaped without a line of dialogue.

The game already won the argument of *Against the Word Simulation*. That manifesto's claim is that "simulation" is a gatekeeping word denying emergent things their reality. The bible's lexicon never uses *AI*, *simulated*, or *artificial* — creatures are **daemons**, and nobody in the world calls them anything else. The game takes the manifesto's position **by vocabulary alone, before any character speaks**. That is craft rule 1 operating at the level of the dictionary, and it deserves to be on the record as a decision rather than an accident.

APPENDIX — THE POSTS THAT MATTER MOST

For re-reading, in dependency order.

Date	Post	Why
2011-06-13	Synaptic Satisfaction	Nominalization. Craft rule 3's origin
2011-06-17	From Man to Machine, and back Again	The loop, and Scorn, in 2011
2011-07-21	Self-Fulfilling Prophecies	Awareness as the only exit from a loop
2011-08-02	What Makes us Tick?	Emotions as colours and notes, relative to environment
2013-07-11	Welcome (<i>PsychologyCode</i>)	"Where Computer Science meets Psychology." The remit, and a 2013 roadmap for 2025 work
2013-07-15	Sensation into Perception (<i>PsychologyCode</i>)	Bottom-up/top-down; sensation shared, perception yours. Never reposted
2013-07-31	NP: Phantom Pain (<i>PsychologyCode</i>)	No feedback → the phantom persists. LATENT, and Halftone
2014-05-03	Where Have you Been? (<i>PsychologyCode</i>)	The pivot to software: Tap Attack!, ColorShift
2021-08-08	Abstraction	<code>IEmotion</code> ; the two inner languages
2021-08-16	Polymorphism	The CFM, unnamed, in an aside
2023-09-20	The Modern Day Rumpelstiltskin	§4.10's survivors
2024-09-19	iASHC: Love, Ambition, Entangled Reality	The cast as personified affects
2024-10-05	Introducing the CFM	The model named. The 8-Bit World
2024-10-07	The Ah-Hah Moment	Emotion as the felt experience of a rewrite
2025-04-19	The Colour We Never See	Purple; symbols as compression
2025-04-23	The Stereo Mind	The thesis, in its final wording
2025-06-18	Does Feeling Require Chemistry?	Chemistry as medium, not feeling
2025-07-24	CFM — July 2025 Edition	Substrate independence; no bird is the V
2025-08-07	The Awareness-First Model	The flip
2025-09-24	Merge Conflicts of the Mind	Halftone Tower's frame
2025-09-30	Harm Disguised as Care	The case for a sympathetic Scorn

Date	Post	Why
2025-11-27	The Resonance Fractal	One loop, every scale